

Unit 1 – Grammar: Verb tenses

Present simple					
Usos	Acciones habituales y rutinas		<i>I go to bed at 11 pm every night.</i>		
			<i>He water his plants three times a week.</i>		
	Hechos generales o verdades universales		<i>Water boils at 100°C.</i>		
			<i>The Earth orbits the Sun.</i>		
	Estados permanentes		<i>She works in a bank.</i>		
			<i>I live in Sevilla.</i>		
	Con verbos estáticos (*)		<i>I love reading fantasy books.</i>		
			<i>She owns a house in Marbella.</i>		
Horarios y programas fijos (futuro programado)		<i>The train leaves at 5 pm.</i>			
		<i>The workshop starts at 8 am.</i>			
Estructura	Afirmativa				
	Sujeto		Verbo (forma base)	Complemento	
	I / You / We / They		like	tea.	
	He / She / It		likes	tea.	
	Negativa				
	Sujeto		Aux + NOT + verbo	Complemento	
	I / You / We / They		do NOT (don't) like	tea.	
	He / She / It		does NOT (doesn't) like	tea.	
	Interrogativa				
	Aux		Sujeto	Verbo	Complemento
	Do		I / You / We / They	like	tea?
	Does		He / She / It	like	tea?
	Expresiones temporales	Every day, usually, often, always, never, sometimes, on Mondays, at the weekend, once a week, twice a month...			
(*) Verbos estáticos	- Emociones y sentimientos: dislike, hate, hope, like, love, need, prefer, want... - Pensamiento y opinión: believe, forget, know, remember, think... - Precios y medidas: cost, measure, weigh... - Posesión: belong, have, cost...				

Present continuo			
Usos	Acciones que ocurren en el momento de hablar	<i>They are watching TV at the moment.</i>	
		<i>She is studying in her room.</i>	
	Situaciones temporales	<i>I'm working in Barcelona for a few months.</i>	
		<i>He's living with his parents this summer.</i>	

	Acciones repetidas con molestia		<i>They're always interrupting me!</i>
			<i>You're complaining about everything all the time.</i>
	Situaciones que están en proceso de cambio o desarrollo.		<i>It's getting dark, let's go home.</i>
			<i>My English is improving a lot.</i>
	Planes personales ya decididos para el futuro cercano		<i>I'm meeting my friends tonight.</i> <i>She's having a date tomorrow.</i>
Estructura	Afirmativa		
	Sujeto	To be + V -ing	Complemento
	I / You / He / She / It / We / They	am / are / is + playing	tennis.
	Negativa		
	Sujeto	To be + NOT + V -ing	Complemento
	I / You / He / She / It / We / They	am / are / is + NOT + playing	tennis.
	Interrogativa		
	To be (aux)	Sujeto	V -ing Complemento
Expresiones temporales	Am / Are / Is	I / You / He / She / It / We / They	playing tennis?
	Now, right now, at the moment, this year, at present, today, these days, this month...		

Present simple & continuous - Exercises

1 Complete the sentences with the present simple or present continuous form of the verbs in brackets.

- Every year, our company _____ (organize) a big charity event in December.
- Look at the sky! It _____ (get) darker and darker.
- My brother usually _____ (take) the bus, but today he _____ (walk) because the weather is nice.
- I can't talk right now — I _____ (have) lunch with some colleagues.
- Maria _____ (not understand) why you're always late.
- The shop usually _____ (close) at 8 p.m., but this week it _____ (stay) open until 10 because of the sales.
- At the moment, we _____ (work) on a new project for an international client.

8. He never _____ (eat) vegetables, which is why he _____ (feel) tired so often.
9. I _____ (see) the dentist tomorrow at 5 — I booked the appointment last week.
10. Students often _____ (forget) their homework if I don't remind them.

2 Write sentences using present simple or continuous with the verbs and words below. Use the affirmative, negative or interrogative form.

1. (she / usually / go / to the gym / before work)
2. (we / work / on / a special project / this week / ?)
3. (they / not / believe / in / horoscopes)
4. (it / rain / a lot / at the moment)
5. (he / meet / his friends / tonight)
6. (you / study / English / this semester / ?)

3 Complete the text with the present simple or present continuous form of the verbs in brackets.

Every year, our family (1) _____ (travel) to the mountains for a week in August. We usually (2) _____ (rent) the same wooden cabin near a lake, and we (3) _____ (spend) our days hiking, swimming, and reading. Right now, as I (4) _____ (write) this message, my parents _____ (pack) the car and my sister (5) _____ (look) for her sunglasses. It's a tradition that everyone (6) _____ (look) forward to all year because it (7) _____ (mean) time away from work and school.

This year, we (8) _____ (leave) earlier than usual because my dad (9) _____ (have) some extra days off. The weather forecast (10) _____ (say) it's going to be sunny all week, which is perfect. Normally, my grandmother (11) _____ (come) with us, but this time she (12) _____ (stay) home because she (13) _____ (feel) a bit tired.

Pasado simple				
Usos	Acciones finalizadas en un momento específico del pasado.		<i>I visited Rome in 2019.</i>	
			<i>We watched a film last night.</i>	
	Acciones consecutivas en pasado		<i>I woke up, had breakfast and went to school.</i>	
			<i>They arrived, unpacked their things and went for a walk.</i>	
Estructura	Afirmativa			
	Sujeto	Verbo (-ed / 2ª columna)	Complemento	
	I / You / He / She / It / We / They	talked	to them.	
	Negativa			
	Sujeto	Did + NOT + verbo (forma base)	Complemento	
	I / You / He / She / It / We / They	did NOT (didn't) talk	to them.	
	Interrogativa			
	Aux	Sujeto	Verbo	Complemento
	Did	I / You / He / She / It / We / They	talk	to them?
Expresiones temporales	Yesterday, last week / month / year..., two days ago, in 2007, in the 1980s, in the 18th century, then...			
Reglas ortográficas	La adición de -ed en los verbos regulares depende de la terminación de la forma base de este: - En -e muda, se añade solo -d: <i>prove – proved.</i> - En consonante + y, se cambia la y por i antes de añadir -ed: <i>try – tried.</i> - En vocal +l, se suele doblar la l: <i>cancel – cancelled.</i> - En monosílabos de 1 vocal + 1 consonante, se dobla la consonante (excepto w, x, y): <i>stop – stopped.</i> - En polisílabos agudos acabados en 1 vocal + 1 consonante, se dobla la consonante (excepto w, x, y): <i>admit – admitted.</i>			

Pasado continuo		
Usos	Acciones en progreso en un momento concreto del pasado	<i>At 9 pm yesterday, I was having dinner.</i>
		<i>They were studying all night.</i>
		<i>I was cooking when you called me.</i>

	Para describir una acción larga (pasado continu) interrumpida por otra acción corta (pasado simple)		They were walking back home when they heard the news.					
	Dos acciones simultáneas en pasado		I was reading while he was cooking dinner.					
			She giving me directions while I was driving.					
Estructura	Afirmativa							
	Sujeto		To be (pasado) + V -ing		Complemento			
	I / You / He / She / It / We / They		was / were + playing		tennis.			
	Negativa							
	Sujeto		To be (pasado) + NOT + V -ing		Complemento			
	I / You / He / She / It / We / They		was / were + NOT + playing		tennis.			
	Interrogativa							
	To be (pasado)		Sujeto		V -ing		Complemento	
	Was / Were		I / You / He / She / It / We / They		playing		tennis?	
Expresiones temporales	Last night / week / year..., yesterday, at 4 pm, when, while...							

Past simple & continuous – Exercises

1 Complete the sentences with the past simple or past continuous form of the verbs in brackets.

- While I _____ (walk) through the park yesterday evening, I _____ (see) a beautiful sunset.
- She _____ (cook) dinner when the lights suddenly _____ (go) out.
- At 9 p.m. last night, we _____ (watch) the final episode of our favourite series.
- He _____ (not hear) the phone because he _____ (listen) to music with his headphones on.
- As the teacher _____ (explain) the exercise, two students _____ (start) arguing.
- When I _____ (cook) dinner yesterday, she _____ (set) the table for us.

7. We _____ (have) lunch in a small café when it suddenly _____ (start) to snow.
8. While my parents _____ (paint) the living room, my brother and I _____ (clean) the garage.
9. She _____ (finish) her presentation on time yesterday, despite the technical problems.
10. What _____ (you / do) at 10 o'clock last night?

2 Write sentences using past simple or past continuous with the words below. Use the affirmative, interrogative and negative form.

1. (they / travel / to Portugal / last summer)
2. (we / have dinner / when / the phone / ring)
3. (she / not / study / at 8 p.m. / yesterday)
4. (I / walk / home / while / my sister / talk / on the phone)
5. (he / break / his glasses / while / he / play / basketball)
6. (he / read / a book / when / the storm / start)

3 Complete the text with the present simple or present continuous form of the verbs in brackets.

Last weekend, I (1) _____ (decide) to visit my cousin in Valencia. While I (2) _____ (drive) along the coast, I (3) _____ (see) a group of dolphins swimming near the shore. It was amazing! When I finally (4) _____ (arrive) at her house, she (5) _____ (prepare) a delicious paella for lunch.

In the afternoon, we (6) _____ (walk) around the city centre and (7) _____ (talk) about our plans for the summer. Suddenly, as we (8) _____ (cross) the main square, a street musician (9) _____ (start) playing one of our favourite songs. We (10) _____ (stop) to listen and (11) _____ (take) a few pictures.

Later that night, while everyone (12) _____ (dance) at the party, my cousin (13) _____ (tell) me a funny story about her new job. It was one of the best weekends I (14) _____ (have) in a long time.

Presente perfecto simple				
Usos	Para hablar de experiencias sin especificar cuando.		<i>I have been to Paris three times.</i>	
			<i>I have never tried sushi</i>	
	Para acciones del pasado que continúan en el presente.		<i>I have lived in this house for 10 years.</i>	
			<i>We have known each other for ages..</i>	
	Para acciones del pasado cuyas consecuencias se pueden ver en el presente.		<i>She has broken her arm.</i>	
			<i>I have lost my phone.</i>	
Para acciones en un pasado muy reciente.		<i>Have you just talked to my mum?</i>		
		<i>I have just checked my messages.</i>		
Estructura	Afirmativa			
	Sujeto	have/has + V (-ed / 3ª columna)	Complemento	
	I / You / He / She / It / We / They	have/has worked	here	
	Negativa			
	Sujeto	have/has + NOT + V (-ed / 3ª columna)	Complemento	
	I / You / He / She / It / We / They	haven't/hasn't worked	here	
	Interrogativa			
	Have/Has	Sujeto	V (-ed / 3ª columna)	Complemento
	Have/Has	I / You / He / She / It / We / They	worked	here?
Expresiones temporales	For:			
	- I've studied English for ten years			
	- He hasn't had a day off for two months			
	Since			
	- I've lived in this city since 2015.			
	- We've known each other since we were children.			
	Already			
	- She has already seen that movie.			
	- We've already had lunch.			
	Just			
- He's just arrived home.				
- They've just realised their mistake.				
Yet				
- I haven't finished the report yet.				
- She hasn't called me yet.				
Still				
- I still haven't found my keys.				

	- He still hasn't decided what to do. Ever - Have you ever met a famous person? - Have they ever been to Japan? Never - I've never seen the snow before. - She's never been late to work. Always - I've always wanted to visit Australia. - They've always lived near the sea. Recently - She has recently started a new car - Have you seen him recently? Lately - I've felt really tired lately - Have you noticed any changes lately? How long - How long have you lived in Madrid? - How long has he worked here?
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Presente perfecto continuo				
Usos	Acciones que empezaron en el pasado y continúan en el presente con un énfasis en la duración.		<i>I have been working here since 2015.</i>	
			<i>They have been dating ever since.</i>	
	Para acciones recientes con efectos en el presente.	<i>I have been painting my room.</i>		
		<i>Have you been working out?</i>		
Estructura	Afirmativa			
	Sujeto	have/has + been + V (ing)	Complemento	
	I / You / He / She / It / We / They	have/has been working	here	
	Negativa			
	Sujeto	have/has + NOT + been + V (ing)	Complemento	
	I / You / He / She / It / We / They	haven't/hasn't been working	here	
	Interrogativa			
	Have/Has	Sujeto	been + V (ing)	Complemento
	Have/Has	I / You / He / She / It / We / They	been working	here?
	Expresiones temporales	For: - I've been studying English for ten years - They've been waiting for the bus for just two minutes		
Since				

	- I've been living in this city since 2015. - We've been renovating the kitchen since Monday. All day/morning... - I've been cleaning the house all day. - He's been coughing all night. Recently/Lately - He's been practicing the piano recently. - Have you two been arguing much lately? How long - How long have you been having those symptoms? - How long have they been trying to contact me?
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1 Complete the sentences with the present perfect simple or continuous form of the verbs in brackets.

1. I _____ (live) in this city for more than ten years.
2. She _____ (not finish) her project yet; she's still working on it.
3. We _____ (wait) for the bus since half past seven.
4. He _____ (just spill) coffee all over his new laptop.
5. They _____ (know) each other since primary school.
6. My hands are dirty because I _____ (paint) the kitchen all morning.
7. She _____ (never try) Indian food before.
8. It _____ (rain) constantly for the last two days.
9. I _____ (already read) that book twice.
10. He looks tired because he _____ (study) for his exams all week.

2 Write sentences using present perfect simple or continuous with the words below. Use the affirmative, interrogative and negative form.

1. (she / work / here / since March)
2. (they / not finish / their homework / yet)
3. (you / ever / be / to London / ?)
4. (I / wait / for you / all morning)
5. (he / just / break / his phone)
6. (we / not see / each other / for years)
7. (it / snow / since last night)
8. (how long / you / study / English / ?)
9. (they / already / leave / the office)

10. (why / she / cry / recently / ?)

3 Complete the text with the present perfect simple or continuous form of the verbs in brackets.

A Busy Week

This week 1. _____ (be) incredibly busy at work. Our company 2. _____ (launch) a new software update, and everyone 3. _____ (work) extra hours to make sure everything runs smoothly.

I 4. _____ (not sleep) much these days, and I think I need a long weekend soon!

Our manager 5. _____ (already check) the system several times today, but problems 6. _____ (keep) appearing all morning. It's frustrating, but we 7. _____ (learn) a lot from this situation.

To make things worse, the weather 8. _____ (be) awful lately — it 9. _____ (rain) almost every day since Monday. However, despite the stress, I feel proud of what we 10. _____ (achieve) so far.

Pasado perfecto simple			
	Para acciones completadas que tuvieron lugar antes que otras acciones del pasado. Es el pasado del pasado. * La acción más reciente va en pasado simple.		By the time you arrived to the birthday party, Carlos had already left.
			I had just gone to bed before you texted me.
Estructura	Afirmativa		
	Sujeto	had + V (-ed / 3ª columna)	Complemento
	I / You / He / She / It / We / They	had worked	here
	Negativa		
	Sujeto	had + NOT + V (-ed / 3ª columna)	Complemento
	I / You / He / She / It / We / They	hadn't worked	here
	Interrogativa		
	Had	Sujeto	V (-ed / 3ª columna)
	Had	I / You / He / She / It / We / They	worked here?

Expresiones temporales	After: - I went out with my friends after I had finished my homework. - She realised her mistake after she had already talked to them. Already: - I had already finished the report when my boss asked for it. - We had already watched that movie, so he chose another one. Before: - I had never flown before I went to London. - I had closed the door before I realised I had left my keys inside. By the time: - By the time he got to the station, the train had already left. - By the time you called me, I had already cooked my lunch.
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1 Complete the sentences with the past perfect or past simple form of the verbs in brackets.

1. By the time we _____ (arrive) at the station, the train _____ (already/leave).
2. She _____ (finish) her homework before her parents _____ (get) home.
3. After he _____ (lose) his wallet, he _____ (call) the police.
4. They _____ (not/see) the film before they _____ (go) to the cinema last night.
5. When I _____ (open) the door, I realized I _____ (forget) my keys inside.
6. We _____ (already/have) dinner when they _____ (invite) us out.
7. By the time she _____ (turn) thirty, she _____ (travel) to ten countries.
8. After the concert _____ (end), everyone _____ (go) for a drink.
9. He _____ (not/start) studying until he _____ (fail) the first exam.
10. Before we _____ (meet), I _____ (hear) a lot about you.

2 Write sentences using past perfect or past simple with the words below. Use the affirmative, interrogative and negative form.

1. they / already / finish / the project / by the time / the manager / check / it
2. I / not / see / the email / before / I / leave / the office

3. you / ever / meet / her / before / she / join / the company?
4. we / clean / the house / after / the guests / leave
5. he / not / understand / the rules / before / the game / start
6. what / she / do / after / she / finish / university?
7. they / already / close / the shop / by the time / we / arrive
8. I / not / hear / about / that accident / before / you / mention / it
9. where / you / go / after / you / finish / your presentation?
10. she / write / the report / before / her boss / ask / for / it

3 Complete the text with the present perfect simple or continuous form of the verbs in brackets.

Last summer, my friends and I decided to take a road trip across Portugal. None of us

1. _____ (ever/visit) the country before, so we were really excited. We
2. _____ (plan) everything carefully, but things didn't go exactly as expected.

By the time we 3. _____ (reach) Lisbon, we 4. _____ (already/drive) for over eight hours, and everyone was exhausted. We 5. _____ (book) a small hotel, but when we 5. _____ (arrive), they told us they 6. _____ (give) our rooms to someone else!

After we 7. _____ (find) another place to stay, we finally went out for dinner. The food was amazing, and by the end of the evening we all agreed it 8. _____ (be) worth the trouble.

Before we 9. _____ (return) home, we 10. _____ (visit) several beautiful coastal towns and met some wonderful people. It was one of the best trips I've ever had.